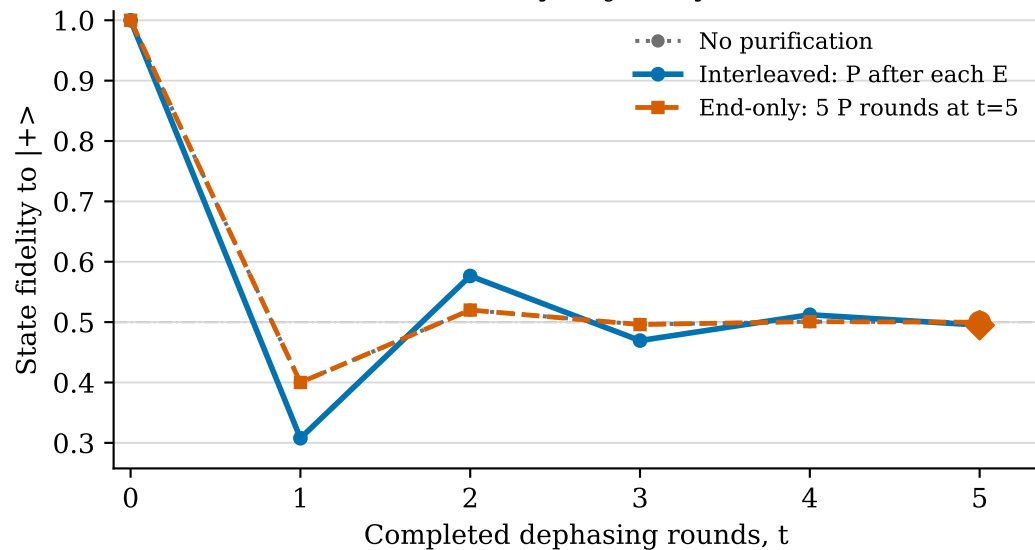


Matched-budget ρ^2 purification: end-only vs interleaved

M=1, $|+\rangle$ initial state, Z dephasing p=0.60; N=32 leaf copies and 31 pairwise merges

Fidelity trajectory



Final fidelity after T=5

